SAP's Global AI Ethics Guiding Principles and Governance Bodies

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Introduction

Recognizing the significant impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on people, our customers, and society, SAP put the globally accepted **UNESCO "Recommendations on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence"** at the core of our **AI Ethics Policy**. These principles are aimed to **steer the development, deployment, sales and use of our AI systems** to help the world run better and improve people's lives.

For us, these guidelines are a commitment to move beyond what is legally required and to begin a deep and continuous engagement with the wider ethical and socioeconomic challenges of AI.

We look forward to expanding our conversations with customers, partners, employees, legislative bodies, and civil society and to making our guiding principles an evolving reflection of these discussions and ever-changing technological landscape.

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SAP's Guiding Principles for Ethical AI

01 Proportionality and do not harm

02 Safety and Security

03 Fairness and non-discrimination

04 Sustainability

05 Right to privacy and data protection

06 Human oversight and determination

07 Transparency and explainability

08 Responsibility and accountability

09 Awareness and literacy

10 Multistakeholder and adoptive governance

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SAP Governance bodies for Ethical AI

SAP Executive Board

Executive sponsorship (CEO)

Sponsor for AI program, approves ethical frameworks and ultimate accountability for high-risk use cases

Global AI Ethics Steering Committee

What

- Approves high-risk use cases
- Decision body for priorities, budget and resources
- Provides recommendations to the Board

Who

Cross-company executive leaders

SAP AI Ethics Office

Governance

- Provide ethical frameworks
- Orchestrate governance process
- Monitor compliance

Operationalization

- Provide guidance for implementing AI Ethics in AI system development

External AI Ethics Advisory Panel

What

Provides constructive, outside-in feedback, perspective and strategic guidance to SAP on ethical AI

Who

Academics, policy experts and industry experts

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01 We ensure proportionality and do not harm via our solutions

We strive to define a clear scope for the AI system and ensure that the AI System's behavior match this scope.

In every stage of AI System lifecycle we define measures that ensure that we remain true to our human rights commitment statement, the UN guiding principles on business and human rights, laws, and widely accepted international norms.

Where there is a conflict with our principles, we will endeavor to ensure our technology does not exceed what is necessary to achieve the goal, and to prevent any inappropriate use.

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02 We uphold safety and security standards

As with any of our products, our AI System through its lifecycle is subject to our quality assurance process, which we continuously adapt when necessary. Our AI Systems undergo thorough testing under real world scenarios to firmly validate that they are fit for purpose and that the product specifications are met.

We work closely with our customers and users to uphold and further improve our systems' quality, safety, reliability, and security

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03 We strive for fairness and non-discrimination

Bias in AI System can harm individuals and our customers by perpetuating societal patterns of marginalization, inequality, and discrimination, especially when there is a risk of causing discrimination or of unjustly impacting underrepresented groups.

Throughout AI system lifecycle we put measures in place to assess and monitor fairness by ensuring representation of all forms of diversity and making reasonable efforts to avoid discriminatory or biased outcomes.

We are also deeply committed to supporting our customers in building even more diverse businesses by leveraging AI to build products that help move business beyond bias.

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04 We are committed to sustainability

We strive to create AI Systems that will foster positive environmental, economic and social impact.

At every stage of the AI System lifecycle we ensure that SAP's sustainability policies are being followed.

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05 We place data protection and privacy at our core

Data protection and privacy are a corporate requirement and at the core of every product and service. We communicate clearly how, why, where, and when customer and anonymized user data is used in our AI System.

This commitment to data protection and privacy is reflected in our commitment to all applicable regulatory requirements. In addition, it is reflected through the research we conduct in partnership with leading academic institutions to develop the next generation of privacy, enhancing methodologies and technologies

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06 We safeguard human oversight and determination

At SAP we follow Human Centered approach for Business AI.

We put in place appropriate governance mechanism to achieve human intervention and control where required at every stage of AI System lifecycle.

The extend of necessary oversight within AI Systems is evaluated depending on the solutions' context and risks of interference with the rights and freedoms of the affected individuals.

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07 We enable transparency and explainability

Our systems are held to specific standards in accordance with their level of technical ability and intended usage. Their input, capabilities, intended purpose, and limitations will be communicated clearly to our customers.

We ensure that end users are made aware about their interaction with an AI System. We strive to provide clear and understandable explanations of recommendations and decisions of the AI System.

We actively support industry collaboration and will conduct research to further system transparency.

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08 We carry responsibility and accountability

While AI Systems can be incredibly advanced, they are not meant to completely replace human responsibility and accountability.

We put in place governance mechanisms, impact and policy compliance assessments to ensure that AI Systems are developed, deployed, sold, and used ethically and responsibly.

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09 We promote awareness and literacy

We provide courses and learning materials accessible for everyone on the topic of AI and its responsible use. We sponsor and organize educational events and encourage exchanges around the topic.

Furthermore, we commit ourselves to promote global initiatives on digital literacy and access.

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10 Multi-stakeholder and adaptive governance and collaboration

While we have control, to a large extent, over the preceding areas and commit to ensure human-centered approach to AI systems, there are numerous emerging challenges that require a much broader discourse across industries, disciplines, borders, and cultural, philosophical, and religious traditions.

We look forward to making SAP one of many active voices in these debates by engaging with our AI Ethics Advisory Panel and a wide range of partnerships and initiatives.

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